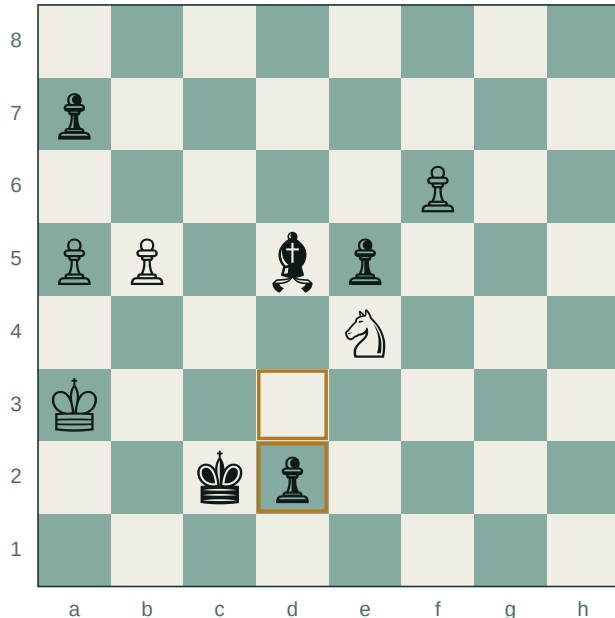


Calculated sacrifices: White, move 49

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 48...d2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

49. Nxd2 Kxd2 50. b6 axb6 51. axb6

49.Nxd2 The knight captures the pawn on d2. Recorded reply: **49...Kxd2**.

50.b6 The pawn moves from b5 to b6. Recorded reply: **50...axb6**.

51.axb6 The pawn captures the pawn on b6.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -2: the balance goes from +0 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on c2. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d5. Check for tactical protection.